STREAMLINING IT PROCUREMENT: AUTOMATING STANDARD LAPTOP ORDERS WITH FLOW DESIGNER

PROJECT DEVELOPMENT PHASE

1. Introduction

The Project Development phase focuses on implementing the proposed IT procurement automation in the ServiceNow platform.

The main purpose of the development is to automate the Standard Laptop ordering process. When a Standard Laptop request is approved, the system should automatically create a Catalog Task and assign it to the Hardware team for configuration.

The development is carried out using Flow Designer, Service Catalog, Requested Item, and Catalog Task.

2. Development Process

The project development is divided into three main milestones:

1. Flow Creation
2. Flow Assignment
3. Standard Laptop Service Catalog Process

3. Milestone 1 – Flow Creation

The first development activity is to create a Flow that automatically creates a Catalog Task for the Standard Laptop request.

Step 1 – Open Flow Designer

1. Open the ServiceNow instance.
2. Navigate to All.
3. Search for Flow Designer.
4. Open Flow Designer.
5. Click New.
6. Select Flow.

Step 2 – Configure the Flow

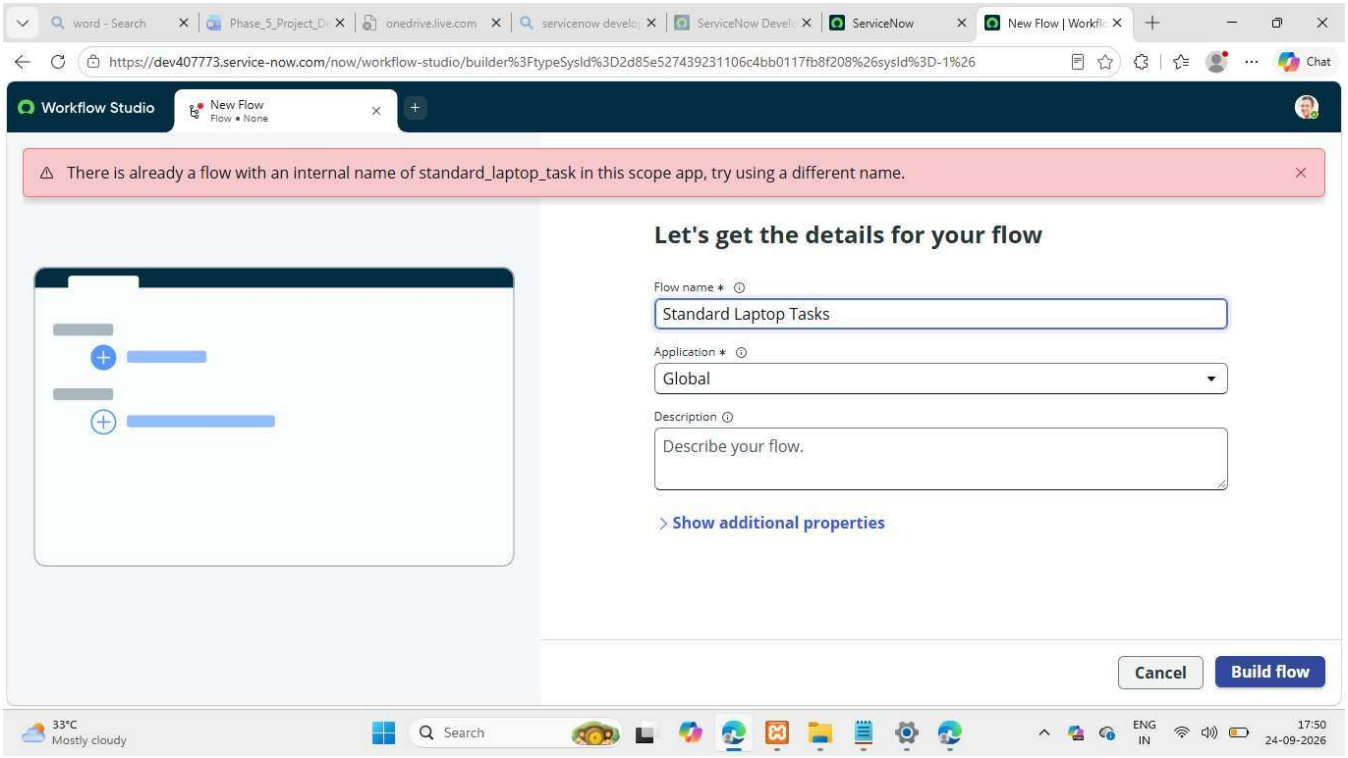
Enter the following details:

Field	Value
Flow Name	Standard Laptop Task
Application	Global
Run As	System User

After entering the details, click Submit.

The project document specifies the Flow name, Global application, and System User configuration.

Screenshot 1: Add screenshot of the created Flow.

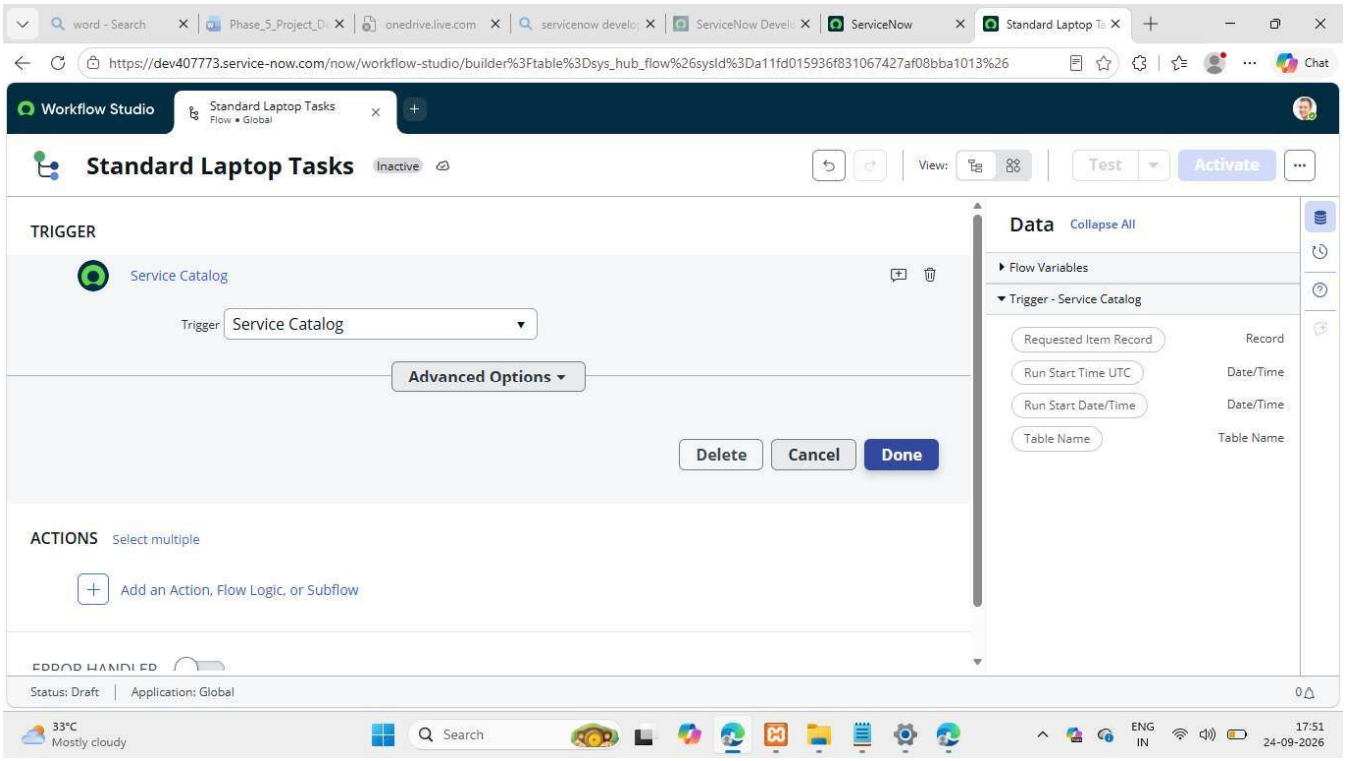


Step 3 – Add Trigger

7. Click Add a Trigger.
8. Search for Service Catalog.
9. Select the Service Catalog trigger.
10. Complete the trigger configuration.
11. Click Done.

The Service Catalog trigger is used to start the Flow process.

Screenshot 2: Add screenshot of the Service Catalog trigger.



Step 4 – Add Action

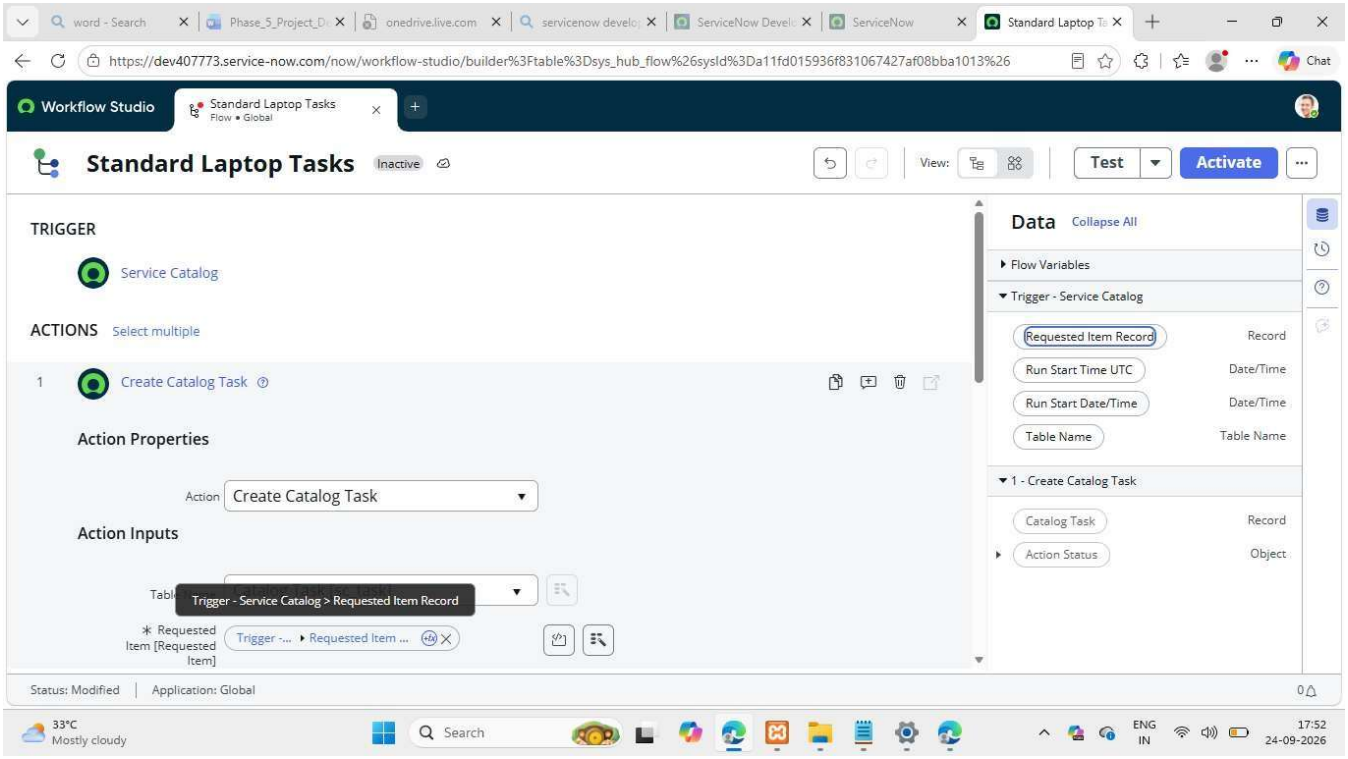
12.Click Add an Action.

13.Search for Create Catalog Task.

14.Select Create Catalog Task.

The project document specifies Create Catalog Task as the action used in the Flow.

Screenshot 3: Add screenshot of the Create Catalog Task action.



Step 5 – Configure Catalog Task

Configure the action using the following values:

Request Item

Drag and drop the Requested Item Record into the Request Item field.

The Table field will automatically populate as Catalog Task.

Short Description

Laptop need to Configured

Description

Add a field value for Description and enter: Laptop need to Configured

Assignment Group

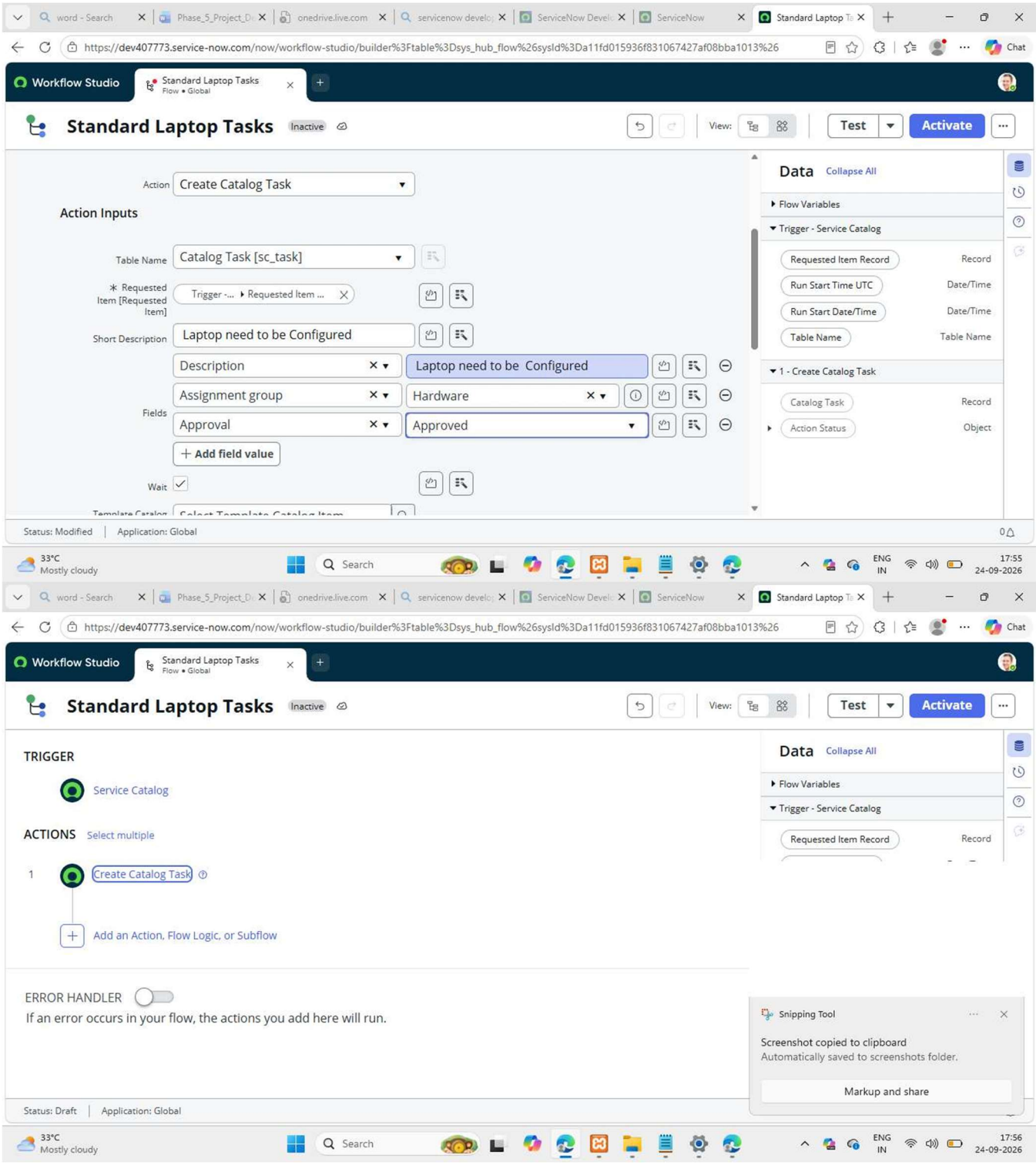
Select: Hardware

Approval

Select: Approved

The project document specifies these Catalog Task values and configuration.

Screenshot 4: Add screenshot showing the completed Catalog Task configuration.



Step 6 – Save and Activate Flow

15.Click Done.

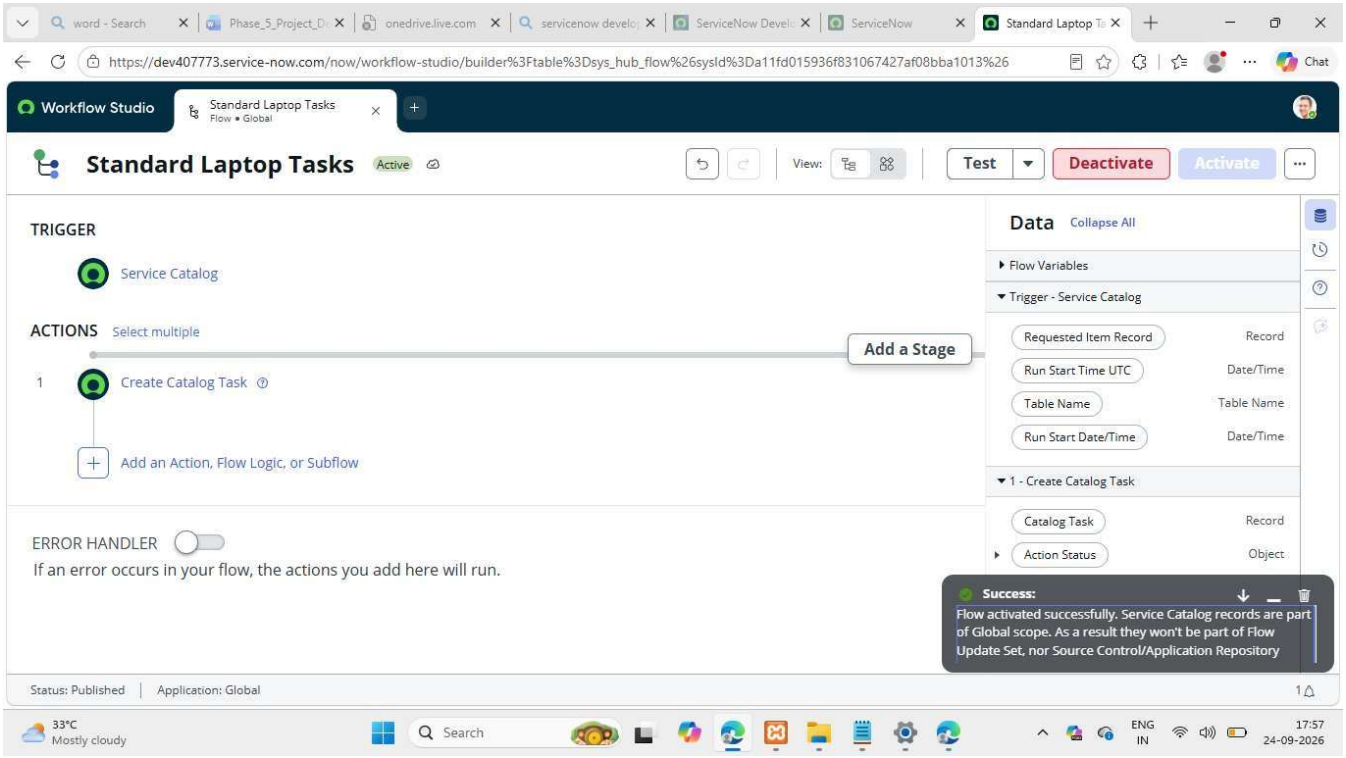
16.Save the Flow.

17.Activate the Flow.

18.Confirm the activation if required.

The Flow must be activated so that the automation can execute.

Screenshot 5: Add screenshot showing the activated Flow.



4. Milestone 2 – Flow Assignment

After creating and activating the Flow, it must be associated with the Standard Laptop catalog item.

Step 1 – Open Maintain Items

19.Navigate to All.

20.Search for Maintain Items.

21.Open Maintain Items.

Step 2 – Open Standard Laptop

Search for Standard Laptop in the Name field.

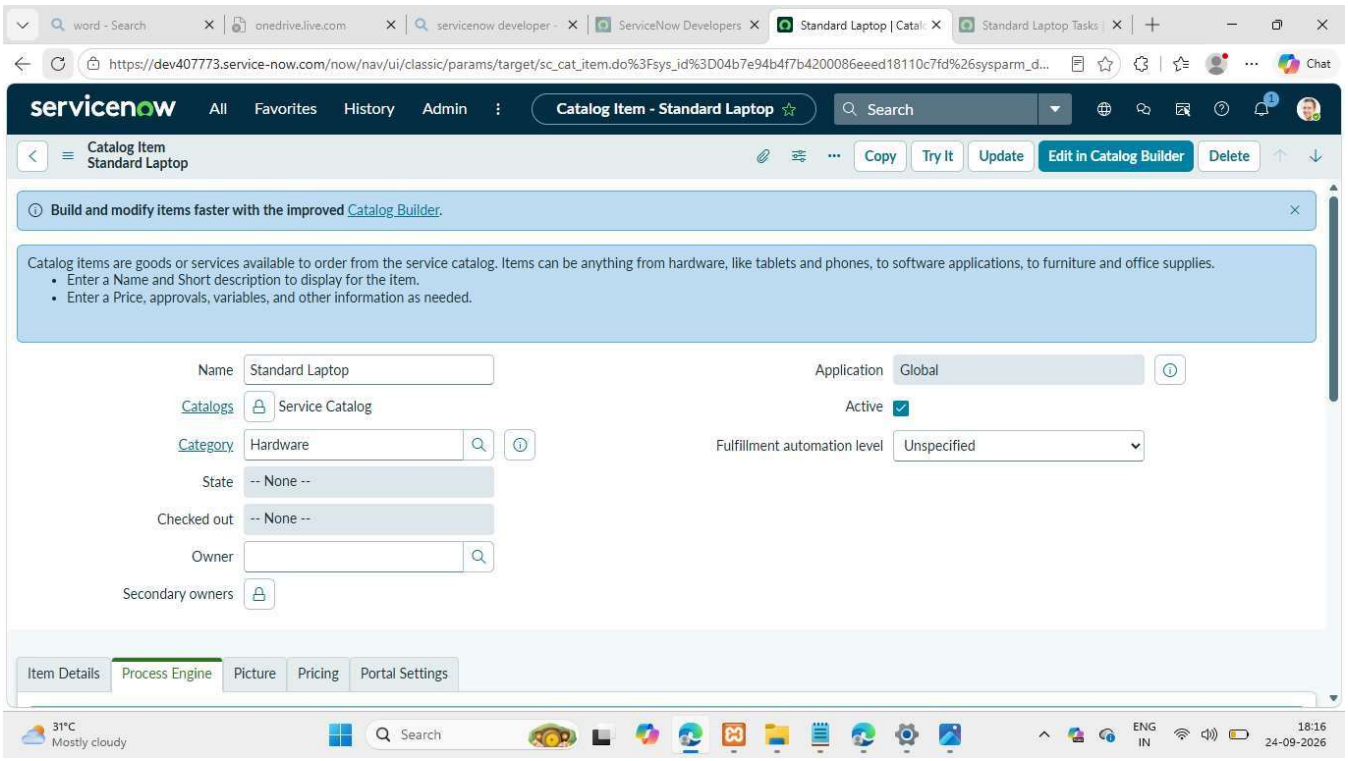
22.Select the Standard Laptop record.

Step 3 – Configure Process Engine

23.Open Process Engine.
24.Remove the remaining automations as specified in the project instructions.
25.Add a Flow.
26.Select Standard Laptop Task.
27.Save the configuration.

These steps follow the Flow Assignment milestone in the project document.

Screenshot 6: Add screenshot showing the Standard Laptop Process Engine configuration.



5. Milestone 3 – Standard Laptop Service Catalog

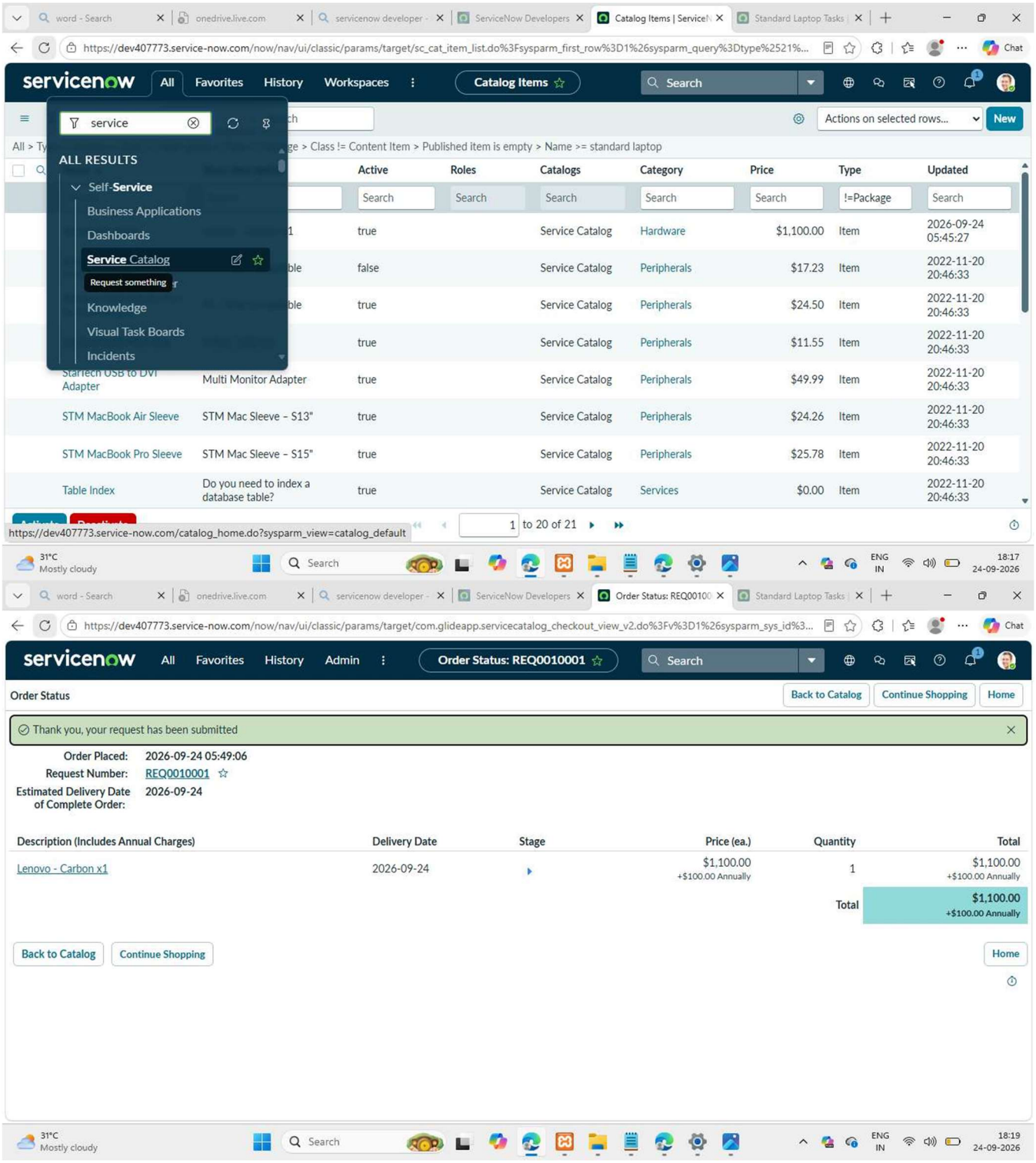
After assigning the Flow, the Standard Laptop request process can be initiated through the Service Catalog.

Step 1 – Open Service Catalog

28.Navigate to All.
29.Open Service Catalog.
30.Select Hardware.
31.Select Standard Laptop.
32.Click Order Now.

The project document specifies this Standard Laptop ordering process.

Screenshot 7: Add screenshot of the Standard Laptop Service Catalog item.



Step 2 – Check Order Status

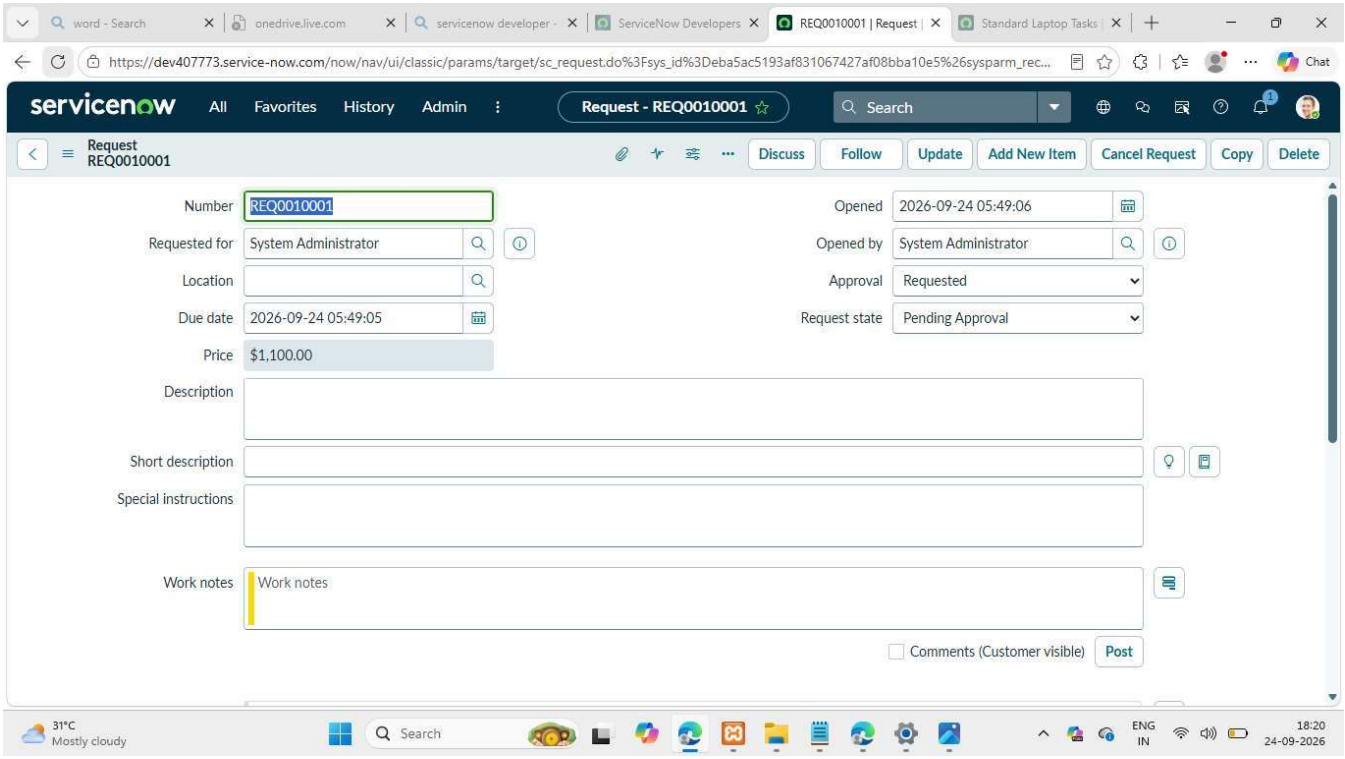
33.Open View Order Status.

34.Click the Request Number.

35.Open the Requested record.
36.Check the Approvers section.

The request is then processed through the approval process.

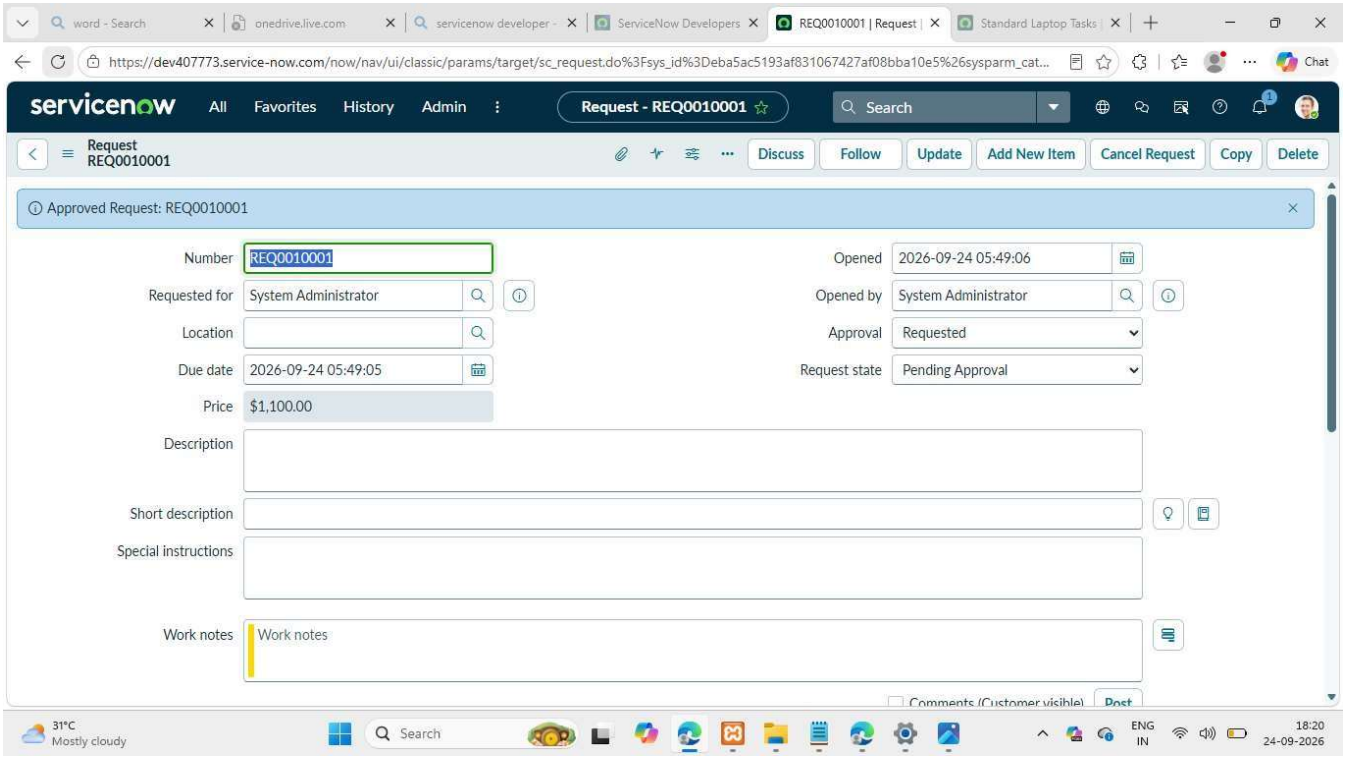
Screenshot 8: Add screenshot showing the request and approval section.



Step 3 – Approve the Request

37.Right-click the record.
38.Select Approve.
39.Open the Requested Item section.
40.Open the Requested Item.

Screenshot 9: Add screenshot showing the approved request.



Step 4 – Check Catalog Task

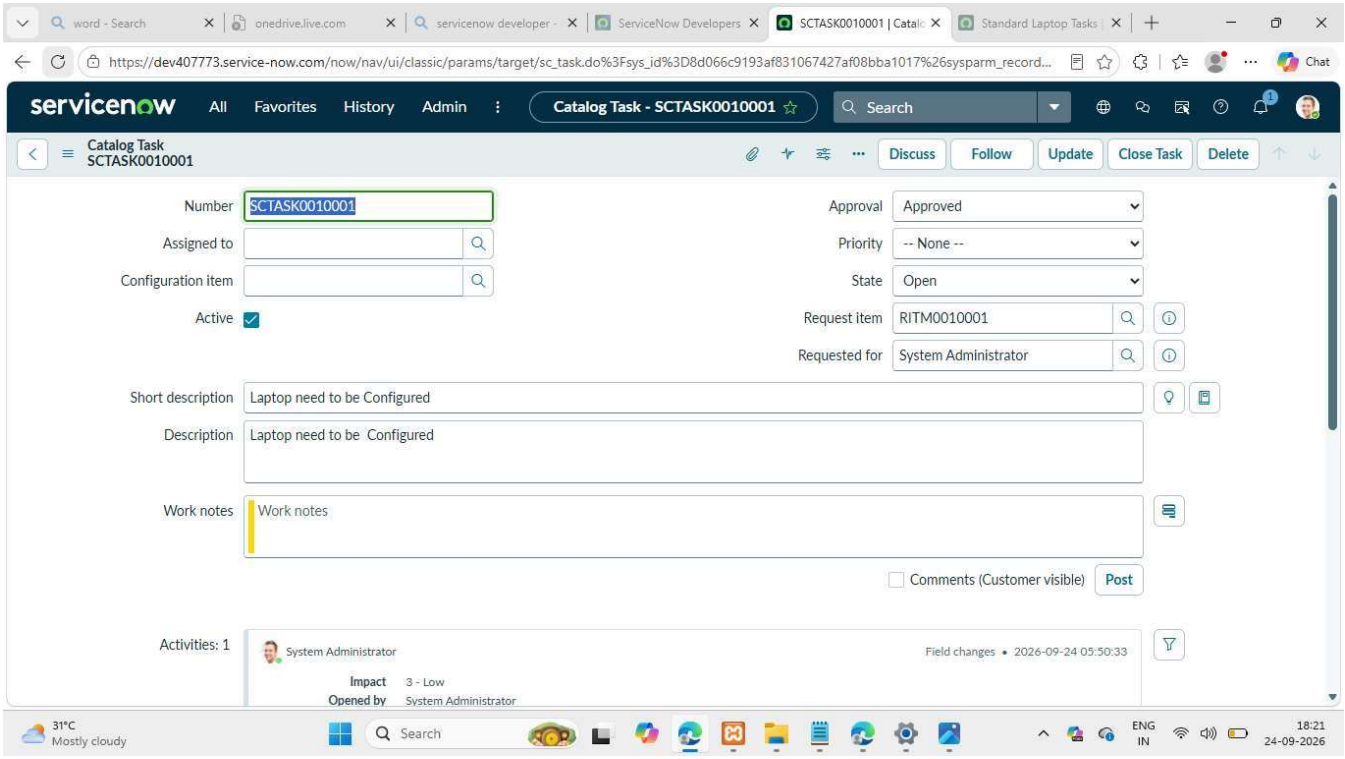
Open the Catalog Tasks section.

The automatically created task can then be opened to verify:

- Task status
- Short Description
- Assignment Group

The project document specifically instructs verifying these details in the generated Catalog Task.

Screenshot 10: Add screenshot showing the generated Catalog Task.



6. Development Output

After completing the development process, the following components are implemented:

- Standard Laptop Task Flow
- Service Catalog Trigger
- Create Catalog Task Action
- Laptop configuration description
- Hardware Assignment Group
- Approved request processing
- Standard Laptop Service Catalog integration

The developed workflow connects the Standard Laptop request with automatic Catalog Task creation and Hardware assignment.

7. Development Workflow

Standard Laptop

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Order Now

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Request Created

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Approval

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Flow Designer Trigger

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Create Catalog Task

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Laptop need to Configured

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Assignment Group: Hardware

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Configuration Task

8. Conclusion

The Project Development phase implements the automated Standard Laptop procurement workflow in ServiceNow.

The Flow is created and activated, assigned to the Standard Laptop catalog item, and connected to the Service Catalog ordering process. Once the request is approved, the Flow creates the required Catalog Task and assigns it to the Hardware group.

This completes the development of the proposed IT procurement automation.